

Brian Kopleck

[linkedin.com/in/briankgames](https://www.linkedin.com/in/briankgames)

brian@kopleck.com

Seattle, WA

Game designer with a systems focus and tech background

EXPERIENCE

Senior Game Designer, Riot Games / MAY 2021 - PRESENT

for unannounced early-stage R&D game

- Scoped early design direction and product strategy, focused on defining around-game systems and features

for *Legends of Runeterra*, an IP-driven mobile/PC collectible card game that pivoted to a PvE roguelite deckbuilder

- Owned economy after PvE pivot, designing new progression that increased 2024 revenue to 160% of first forecast
- Led design of two PvP sets and designed champion kits, adventures, events, quests, and features for PvE mode
- Served on the game leadership team to guide high-level game direction, led and mentored 5 design contractors
- Authored release-quality content scripts in Python, emphasizing code readability and robustness
- Communicated design and direction in dev videos and posts as a public-facing voice for players
- Promoted to Senior Game Designer in 2023

Systems Designer, WB Games San Francisco / MAY 2019 - NOV 2020

for unreleased IP-driven hero collector mobile game

- Pitched and prototyped a combat system that streamlined the genre's standard, validated in external playtests
- Drove high-level design for combat abilities, team/character kits, and intended archetypes for PvP metagame
- Wrote design specs for features, including a guild PvP mode, procedurally generated gear, and battle UX flows

Senior Game Designer, Big Fish Games / APR 2016 - APR 2019

for *Gambit Card Battler*, a mobile collectible card game with real-time battles

- Led team from concept to launch with earned featuring on iOS & Android, average engagement of 30 min/day
- Designed core combat for strategic real-time gameplay within constraints of 4 min match times and 1 sec latency
- Designed and implemented 100 card set of resonant units and spells across seven factions with distinct playstyles
- Designed collection economy that supported satisfying monetization and longtail progression with limited set size

for *Big Fish Casino*, a mobile social casino game

- Designed and tuned eleven unique slot machines, including *Sugar Dash*, a top-10 engagement hit for 6 years
- Designed live-ops features like tournaments and meta collection events tuned for casino audience accessibility
- Promoted to Senior Game Designer in 2017

Game Designer & Producer, Ruddy Games (self-published side project) / SEP 2014 - JAN 2016

for *Skulldug*, a competitive pulp adventure board game for 1-6 players

- Designed and produced from game jam concept to Kickstarter release with 220% of funding goal
- Ran playtests, iterated on game rules & balance, designed rulebook layout & graphics, and gave art direction

Game Engineer II, Big Fish Games / SEP 2013 - APR 2016

for *Big Fish Casino*, a mobile social casino game

- Wrote fullstack code in JavaScript & PHP for slot machines, features, and internal tools
- Promoted to Game Engineer II in 2015

EDUCATION

B.Sc. in *Computer Science: Game Design*
from UC Santa Cruz
2009 - 2013

SKILLS & TOOL EXPERIENCE

C#, JavaScript, Python
Git (GUI & CLI), Github
Jira & Confluence
Unity

Google Docs, Slides,
Sheets, and App Script
Airtable
Claude Code

INTERESTS

Mentor with *Gameheads* (5 years), Magic: the Gathering, international travel